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Instagram videos

Facebook-owned photo sharing network Instagram to now allow users to upload and share their videos.

Accelerated Processing Units (APUs) which can be divided into three broad segments. At the higher end there were the Richland APUs which will be targetted at the high-performance ultrathins and desktops. At the mid-level we have the Kabini SoC, which will be seen in ultrathins and finally at the lower-end Temash SoC which will be seen in tablets and hybrid devices that are under 13-inch in screen size. The flagship Richland APU for the desktop will be the A10-6800K and it comes with integrated Radeon HD 8670 graphics. (Do not forget to read our review of the same in the Bazaar section.)

AMD also showcased its fourth-gen APU codenamed Kaveri, which will be seen sporting the Steamroller CPU architecture and Graphics Core Next GPU architecture. It will also be the first APU to ship with Heterogeneous System Architecture (HSA) which basically is AMD's plan to let the CPU and

GPU share cache memory which will not only give a performance boost to the APUs but also make them more power efficient. This also allows developers to code applications which can utilise both the CPU as well as the GPU prowess depending on the situation. AMD had a demo of the Kaveri APU running Devil May Cry 3.

Seagate

Seagate introduced some interesting products at Computex 2013. Let us start off with their better-late-than-never foray into a new product category: Solid state drives. Currently it has three series: Seagate 600, Seagate 600 Pro and the Seagate 1200. Of the three series, the consumer oriented ones come in 120GB, 240GB and 480GB capacities in the Seagate 600 series SSDs. These SSDs come with the Link-A-Media LM87800 controller which was last seen in Corsair Neutron GTX SSDs. The 600 series SSD



Seagate 600 series SSD

comes with a 5mm as well as 7mm z-height.

Apart from the SSDs, Seagate also introduced a 5mm thin laptop drive targetted at OEMs. But the interesting products from a consumer perspective were the solid state hard drives (SSHD) that were announced. These were on display in capacities such as 500GB and 1TB for the laptop and 1TB, 2TB and 4TB for the desktops. The desktop hybrid drives are the first of its kind though. We were a bit surprised to see no performance hit despite using a 5400 RPM drive and an MLC NAND instead of the 7200 RPM and SLC NAND used in previous generation drives. But Seagate representatives told us that the caching algorithms had been improved. We can confirm this statement only after testing the third generation laptop SSHDs. The main reason to go with 5400 RPM drives was attributed to keeping the power consumption on the lower side, as according to Seagate

these SSHDs will be seen in future laptops and Ultrabooks where battery life is important.

Souped-up Motherboards

Since Intel announced its Haswell platform here, we had expected a blitzkrieg of motherboards from various brands. And we were not disappointed. In fact, we even came across some brands which do not sell boards in India such as Galaxy and EVGA (which only sell graphics cards), sporting a range of Z87 boards. Sure most of the popular brands also sported AMD boards, but the Haswell platform had comparatively higher number of boards. Whether that's a coincidence or by design, we'll leave that up to you to decide. Now, since it is not possible to cover each and every board launched at Computex, we decided to cherry pick the ones that caught our fancy and which we expect to test out soon. So let us take a quick tour of the popular brands.

ASUS

The Republic of Gamers series had some seriously wonderful looking boards. The Maximus VI Extreme – the flagship of the ROG series – in keeping with its traditional red and black colour offered some interesting features such as 4-way GPU setup, sub-zero sense, overclocking utilities



ASUS Maximus VI Extreme with the OC Panel



FATALITY VS RELIC

One of the highlights of our Computex visit has to be us bumping into none other than Fatal1ty aka Johnathan Wendel – living, breathing gaming royalty. We were giggling like little school-girls in Fatal1ty's presence, having witnessed his FPS exploits on games such as Quake 3, Painkiller, Team Fortress, etc. After a brief photo-op, we caught up with him for an exclusive interview (don't miss it in the SKOAR! DVD this month), but not before he won a pro-game against Relic, bagging a cool US \$10,000 in the process. Watch the video here: dgit.in/dgt_cmptx_ftl1ty